POLICY MEMORANDUM · DRAFT v2 · OCTOBER 18TH, 2026

Operations Research and the State's Operational Resilience

Housing, Health, Essential Services, Domestic Energy and the Circular Economy

SUBMITTED TO The Minister for Housing, Local Government and Heritage; the Minister for Transport and Energy; the Joint Committee on Housing, Local Government and Heritage; and the Ombudsman (OMB-260331-CSD014), with the Tairiscint Meinhart.

1. What this asks

One question, answerable by an identifiable body:

Where in the State does the capacity sit to model how housing delivery, health capacity, essential services and energy supply interact under stress, and which office assembles the competences it needs?

If the answer is "nowhere", that finding is itself the answer. A short written reply from either Minister, or from the Ombudsman's inquiry, would settle it.

2. Counting units is not modelling interaction

Housing policy is reported mainly as units: targets announced, completions counted, figures defended in committee. A unit count says nothing about whether each unit has water, grid capacity, transport, employment, services and waste handling behind it. Those are dependencies, and they sit with different Departments, regulators and local authorities.

Operations Research (O.R.) is the discipline that models such dependencies. The Comprehensive Survey of O.R. Sub-Domains (submitted with the memorandum to Government on 5 February 2026) maps its methods to these functions:

FUNCTION	SURVEY SECTION
Where to build, facility location, long-run demand	2 — Supply Chain Network Design; 9 — Forecasting; 12 — Investment Analysis
Local authority operations, land use, waste routing	30 — Smart Cities; 29 — Sustainability
Health capacity, bed and patient flow, pandemic surge	22 — Healthcare Operations; 31 — Humanitarian and Disaster
Grid, storage, load forecasting	21 — Energy Systems
Fuel and goods movement	1 — Shipping and Distribution; 5 — Transportation Networks
Delivery risk on large capital programmes	10 — Risk; 11 — Project Management

The Survey is an overview of capabilities, not a demonstration, and nothing here asks any body to adopt a method.

3. Housing

The Housing Committee and its Clerk received the Survey and a summary on March 2nd, 2026. The Minister for Housing was copied on the correspondence of that date. The record shows no reply that addresses the question of capacity. A reply on method would not answer it either.

Housing delivery depends on grid connection, water, transport and planning, administered separately. Whether anyone models the combined effect on a given location is the open item.

4. Health

The National Strategic Risk Assessment (NSRA) 2026 submission of 9 October 2026 has no standalone health section. Its health content is as follows:

- A pandemic can constrain healthcare capacity, personnel, procurement, transport, inventories, testing and vaccination at once (Part VIII).
- A health-system surge can affect cross-border patient flows (Part IX.H).
- Health, housing and displacement appear as simultaneous exposures in a major extreme-weather event.

Between March and July 2020 the author sent proposals on emergency logistics to the Minister for Health, the Chief Medical Officer and the HSE, and to every member of the Oireachtas. The record shows automated acknowledgements only. If a dedicated health section is wanted, it should be added to the NSRA follow-up. It is not drafted here.

5. Essential services

S.I. No. 559 of 2024 requires the national risk assessment to account for cross-sectoral and cross-border risk and for dependencies between sectors (reg. 11(3), 11(4)(c)). It designates thirteen competent authorities and a single point of contact in the Minister for Defence. It prescribes no method and does not say where the modelling capacity sits.

The State runs three risk exercises, the NSRA, the National Risk Assessment for Ireland 2023 and the National Cyber Risk Assessment, with three owners. In optimisation terms these are three solutions to one coupled problem, with no master problem to reconcile them.

The fuel disruption that began on April 7th, 2026 is a public-record case. Blockades at Whitegate and the Galway and Foynes depots put access to roughly half of national fuel at risk within days. More than 100 forecourts had run dry by April 10th, and the industry body later reported around 600. The National Emergency Coordination Group was convened, and Transport, Energy, Justice, Defence and Finance were all engaged. Transport acknowledged the author’s correspondence on April 8th, 2026 (TTAS-MO-01932-2026). The dates are stated; no causal link is claimed.

6. Domestic energy

Why this is the Transport and Energy Minister’s question

The structural problem is the one in The Gatekeeping Problem. Competence is distributed across the energy regulator, the grid operators, the planning system, local authorities, the Housing Department and Transport, and no statute requires them to assemble into one analysis. The Gatekeeping Brief calls this distributed competence with no coordination requirement.

Where housing and energy meet:

- Data centres consumed 22% of metered electricity in 2024 and 23% in 2025 (CSO). Large energy users accounted for a third.

- Housing, heat, transport electrification and large users draw on one grid, one connection queue and one planning system.
- The all-island electricity market couples supply and pricing across the land boundary, so a contingency engages two jurisdictions.
- Fuel logistics (refinery, depots, ports, road distribution) is a single point of failure that no listed risk owned in April 2026.

The NSRA submission proposes that listed Risk 21 be extended to fuel logistics and cross-boundary electricity. It also proposes Risk 6 (digital infrastructure exposure) and Risk 8 (cross-border coordination capacity). The Department of Transport is also the sponsoring Department in Proposed Risk 7: the Iarnród Éireann Traffic Management System write-down of about €50 million, where three bodies each held part of the decision and none held the whole. No finding is made against any body.

The question for the Minister for Transport and Energy is the same as in section 1, applied to fuel, grid and rail. Which office assembles the competences, and where is the model?

7. The circular economy

The Survey treats waste collection routing, reverse logistics and circular design as established O.R. fields (Sections 1, 29). Construction and demolition materials, local authority waste routing and energy recovery link the housing programme to the energy system. Whether the State models those flows together is, again, an open item. No figures are asserted here.

8. Why the record is relevant

The Interregnum record shows that a capability offered to the State, with a written undertaking to report, produced neither a determination nor a named owner. The NSRA submission lists thirteen reference-numbered acknowledgements from six Departments between June 2024 and September 2026, and none identifies a body that holds the question. A system that cannot say where a question sits also cannot show that housing, health, energy and transport are modelled together.

The design feature in common is that responsibility rotates while the question stays unowned, whether by change of Minister, change of Government or the coalition's scheduled change of Taoiseach in November 2027. This describes the design. It does not describe any individual's conduct.

9. What this submission does not do

- It does not ask the Government to adopt any method, technology or supplier.
- It does not allege fault or bad faith in any office-holder.
- It does not assert that the material is controlled, or that the work would have changed any outcome.
- It does not assert a legal duty on the Ministers or an enforceable promise.
- It takes no position on housing targets or energy policy.

10. Questions answerable yes or no

1	Does the Department of Housing, Local Government and Heritage hold, or have access to, a standing model of how housing delivery interacts with grid, water, transport and waste capacity?
2	Does the Department of Transport and Energy hold one for fuel logistics, the grid and rail?

3	Which office, if any, assembles those competences with the Department of Defence under S.I. 559 of 2024, and does it perform the cross-boundary analysis required by reg. 11(3)?
4	If none exists, will the Minister state so in writing, so that the gap can be recorded in the NSRA?

. Sources

- Statement of Record, Interregnum Nullificans v20e (October 16th, 2026).
- Submission to the NSRA 2026, *Steps to the Recovery from Regulatory Obsolescence* (October 9th, 2026).
- The Gatekeeping Problem (“The Gatekeeping Brief”, October 18th, 2026)
- Comprehensive Survey of O.R. Sub-Domains (February 5th, 2026)
- S.I. No. 559 of 2024
- CSO, Data Centres Metered Electricity Consumption (2024, 2025)
- RTÉ and Irish Times reporting, April 2026
- Correspondence to the Housing and Justice Committees, March 2nd, 2026

REPOSITORY dr-bosch.github.io/nullification-loops